

a widemouthed food processor are a few standard appliance staples. From there, choose only those appliances that will make a huge contribution to your life and cooking styles.

8. Fresh herbs

Buying these from the market often leads to waste, since you can't use it all, and they don't keep well. But these can make a tremendous difference to the flavor of your meals. Having a few pots of your favorite herbs will lower the cost and add to the look and feel of your kitchen environment. Even one really lush healthy plant featuring one of your favorite herbs can make a big decorative statement, such as a potted bay leaf tree or extra large rosemary bush.

9. DIY hanging pot racks

This is another item that can blow your entire budget at design stores. But multitudes of options are available for the DIY folks out there. Re-bar with chain and S-hooks, wagon wheels, antique garden ladders, and old gate sections are just a few. Get creative and have fun with it.

10. Open shelving

You can use this above the countertops as a carryover from the rolling

industrial shelves idea. Just put them as far apart as you want for custom storage that meets your needs. If you are starting a kitchen from scratch, it's a way to scrub those expensive cabinets and save money for more important things like wine and brushed-steel appliances. Another place to go with open shelving can be below the countertops. Curtains in front are a popular way to hide stored items.

— **Myscha Theriault**



21 Great Uses for Beer

I love beer. From a warm, nutty pint of English bitter, to an ice-cold Belgian lager, I'm all over it. But you don't just have to drink beer straight from the bottle or jar (although that's